

Q1 Consider the following statements about the Tamil Nadu 2026-27 Budget:

1. It is the first Budget of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led coalition government headed by C. Joseph Vijay.
2. It was presented by Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson on August 5, 2026.
3. The 'Vettri Tamilagam Vision Document' was organised on the Thirukkural themes of Aram, Porul and Inbam.
4. A Revenue Augmentation Committee was constituted under economist Raghuram Rajan.

Which of the above statements are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1, 2 and 3 only**
- C. 2, 3 and 4 only
- D. 1, 2, 3 and 4



EXPLANATION

The 2026-27 Tamil Nadu Budget is the first Budget of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK)-led coalition government headed by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, presented in the Assembly on August 5, 2026 by Finance Minister N. Marie Wilson. Its policy blueprint, the 'Vettri Tamilagam Vision Document', groups 436 departmental proposals under the Thirukkural-inspired themes of Aram (virtue), Porul (wealth) and Inbam (well-being), mirroring the party's election manifesto. Ahead of the Budget the government released a White Paper pegging the State's outstanding debt, including that of Public Sector Undertakings, at 13.18 lakh crore rupees and flagging a 'revenue collapse'. To shore up finances it set up a Revenue Augmentation Committee under economist Ashok Singh Ahluwalia — not Raghuram Rajan — so statement 4 is the only incorrect one.

Q2 Consider the following statements about the Cauvery water dispute in 2026:

1. The Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) decision of July 30, 2026 directed the release of 3,500 cusecs for 15 days.
2. Tamil Nadu sought the release of 26.954 tmc ft to make good the shortfall at Biligundlu.
3. In July 2026, Tamil Nadu received 31.24 tmc ft at Biligundlu, its best in 50 years.
4. Biligundlu is the inter-State measuring point for Cauvery inflows into Tamil Nadu.

Which of the above statements are incorrect?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 3 only
- C. 2 and 4 only
- D. 1, 3 and 4 only



EXPLANATION

The Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) is the statutory body created under the Cauvery Water Disputes Tribunal's final award (as modified by the Supreme Court in 2018) to enforce monthly water releases between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. On July 30, 2026 the CWMA directed Karnataka to release 3,500 cusecs for 15 days from the Kabini and Krishnaraja Sagara reservoirs, and Tamil Nadu moved the Supreme Court seeking 26.954 tmc ft to make good the shortfall measured at Biligundlu, the inter-State point in Krishnagiri district where inflows have been gauged since 2013. July 2026 was in fact the worst July in 50 years for Tamil Nadu's Cauvery share, with only 0.698 tmc ft realised against the stipulated 31.24 tmc ft. Statement 3 inverts this reality — the State received a mere fraction, not its full share, and it was the worst rather than the best month — so statement 3 is the only incorrect one.

Q3 The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026, passed by the Lok Sabha to replace an earlier ordinance, raises the sanctioned strength of judges in the Supreme Court (including the Chief Justice of India) to which figure?

- A. 34
- B. 37
- C. 39
- D. 41



EXPLANATION

The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Act, 1956 fixes the sanctioned judicial strength of the Court, and has been amended whenever pendency has required a larger Bench pool — most recently to 34 in 2019. The 2026 Amendment Bill, passed by the Lok Sabha to replace an ordinance promulgated earlier in the year, raises that ceiling to 39 judges including the Chief Justice of India. Note that the figure is a ceiling on appointments, not a quorum: the Court routinely functions with vacancies against the sanctioned strength.